

EVIDENCE ROOM

AP AI Readiness Diagnostic

Score your operating readiness for governed AP agents

Tier 0 · Free lead magnet

Operating Evidence · Not legal, tax, or accounting advice

AP AI Readiness Diagnostic

Product: Evidence Room — Free Lead Magnet **Document ID:** ER-FREE-DIAG-001 **Version:** 1.0 **Brand idea:** Operating Evidence **Audience:** CFO, Controller, Head of AP / Shared Services, Finance Transformation **Time to complete:** 45–75 minutes (with one process owner + one systems-aware colleague)

Cover

Evidence Room AP Agent OS · Free Diagnostic

AP AI Readiness Diagnostic

Design operating evidence before you expand autonomy.

This diagnostic scores whether your Accounts Payable function is ready to introduce AI agents under control — not whether you should buy another automation tool.

It produces:

- A 0–100 readiness score with maturity band
- A dimension profile (where you are strong / weak)
- An opportunity heatmap for agent families
- A baseline KPI worksheet
- A business-case starter with labelled assumptions

It does **not** promise savings, fraud detection, compliance certification, or autonomous payments.

Organisation	
Legal entities in scope	
Approximate invoices / month	
ERP / AP stack	
Diagnostic owner	
Date	
Reviewer (Controller / Head of AP)	

1. Positioning — why this exists

Most Finance teams are being asked to “use AI in AP.” The question that matters is narrower:

> Can we design agents with owners, exclusions, exception logic, and measurable evidence — before we let them touch live work?

Vendors sell features. Consultancies sell projects. Prompt packs sell novelty. **Evidence Room** sells the portable **operating layer**: charters, controls, exception taxonomy, KPIs, and a responsibility ladder (L0→L4) that sits across any ERP.

Operating Evidence means: if you cannot show who owned an agent action, what rule applied, what exception code was used, and what changed in the scorecard, you do not expand autonomy.

Payment authorisation stays human at every maturity band described here.

2. How to score (0–100)

2.1 Structure

A. Process clarity	Q1–Q6	18	18%
B. Data & systems	Q7–Q12	18	18%
C. Controls & governance	Q13–Q18	18	18%
D. Exception load	Q19–Q23	15	15%
E. Talent & operating model	Q24–Q28	15	15%
F. AI readiness culture	Q29–Q32	16	16%
Total	32	100	100%

Each question scores **0 / 1 / 2 / 3** unless noted. Use the rubrics below; do not invent intermediate scores.

2.2 Scoring method

- 1 Answer every question with the **current operating reality**, not the target-state slide.
- 2 Where practice differs by entity, score the **primary entity** you intend to pilot first — then note variance.
- 3 Two people should score independently, then reconcile disagreements ≥ 1 point.
- 4 Sum raw points $\rightarrow$ total 0–100.
- 5 Map total to a maturity band (§4).
- 6 Plot dimension averages for the heatmap (§5).

2.3 Dimension average (for heatmap)

For each block, convert to a 0–100 subscore:

$$\text{Subscore} = (\text{points earned} / \text{max points}) \times 100$$

Round to nearest integer.

3. Diagnostic questions (32)

A. Process clarity (Q1–Q6) — 18 points

Q1. Documented invoice-to-pay process Is there a current, used process map for invoice-to-pay (not a 2019 Visio in a shared drive)?

No map, or nobody can find it	Map exists; rarely used; outdated	Map current for primary entity; used in training	Map current, version-controlled, multi-entity variants owned

Q2. Role clarity Can you name who owns intake, matching, exceptions, approvals, and payment proposal preparation?

Roles blur daily	Informal knowledge only	RACI for humans documented	RACI ready to extend to agents

Q3. Policy accessibility Are PO-required rules, tolerance tables, and non-PO paths written and reachable by processors?

Tribal knowledge	Policy exists; hard to find	Policy accessible; gaps known	Policy + tolerances maintained with change control

Q4. Channel inventory Do you know all inbound invoice channels (email, portal, EDI, paper, supplier networks)?

Unknown / “mostly email”	Partial list	Full list with volumes	Full list + owner per channel

Q5. Straight-through definition Is “clean” / STP defined with explicit exclusion criteria?

STP is a slogan	Informal definition	Written STP criteria	STP measured weekly with exclusions logged

Q6. Handoffs Are handoffs between AP, Procurement, Receivers, and Approvers explicit (SLA, artefact, owner)?

Firefighting handoffs	Some SLAs	Written handoffs for top paths	Measured handoffs + escalation clocks

Block A subtotal: ____ / 18

B. Data & systems (Q7–Q12) — 18 points

Q7. Master data health Vendor master quality (duplicates, inactive vendors, incomplete tax IDs) is known and managed.

Unknown	Occasional cleanse	Metrics exist; backlog owned	Stewardship process with cadence

Q8. Document capture quality OCR / capture error rates are measured for critical fields (supplier, amount, invoice #, PO).

Not measured	Anecdotal	Field-level error rates tracked	Error rates drive vendor/channel action

Q9. Match data availability PO, receipt, and invoice line data are reliably available for three-way match where required.

Frequent missing links	Partial	Reliable for core categories	Reliable + service acceptance defined paths

Q10. Audit trail System of record retains who changed coding, approvals, holds, and payment proposals.

Gaps / workarounds	Partial trails	Strong ERP trails	Trails + exportable evidence packs

Q11. Integration readiness AP objects can be read (and later written under control) via API, RPA, or file — without screen folklore only.

UI-only folklore	Some exports	Read integration proven	Read + controlled write pattern designed

Q12. Environment separation There is a non-production path to test agent behaviour against realistic data.

Prod-only experiments	Stale sandbox	Usable test env	Test env + refresh + masked data practice

Block B subtotal: ____ / 18

C. Controls & governance (Q13–Q18) — 18 points

Q13. Segregation of duties SoD between posting, vendor master, and payment authorisation is enforced and reviewed.

Informal	Documented; weakly enforced	Enforced in system	Enforced + periodic certification

Q14. Duplicate controls Duplicate payment / invoice controls exist beyond “be careful.”

Manual memory	Soft system check	Hard block / hold on candidates	Hard block + investigation workflow + evidence

Q15. Delegation of authority DOA is system-enforced for invoice approval amounts.

Email culture	Partial	System DOA for primary entities	System DOA + exception logging

Q16. Payment authorisation Payment release is dual-controlled and explicitly human — no bot “release” narratives.

Ambiguous	Human but poorly evidenced	Clear human auth + evidence	Clear + bank-file controls + sampling

Q17. Vendor bank change Banking / remit-to changes require enhanced verification (not email alone).

|--|--|--|--|

Email-driven risk	Some checks	Formal dual verification	Formal + callback / out-of-band + evidence
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Q18. Change control for automation RPA / AI / workflow changes have owners, testing, and rollback — not silent prod edits.

Ad hoc	Ticket only	Change control for bots	Change control + autonomy registry concept
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Block C subtotal: ____ / 18

D. Exception load (Q19–Q23) — 15 points

Q19. Exception classification Exceptions are coded with a stable taxonomy (not free-text only).

Free-text / none	Informal codes	Stable codes in use	Codes drive ownership + reporting
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Q20. Ageing visibility Aged exceptions are visible by owner, amount, and code.

Hidden in inboxes	Spreadsheet heroics	Dashboard exists	Dashboard used in operating rhythm
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Q21. Volume concentration You know which 5–10 exception types consume most effort.

Unknown	Gut feel	Measured top codes	Measured + root-cause themes
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Q22. Supplier query load Supplier chases and statement noise are quantified.

Unknown	Estimate only	Volume tracked	Volume + response SLA tracked
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Q23. Preventable vs unavoidable The team distinguishes process defects (PO quality, GR lag) from true commercial disputes.

All “AP problems”	Informal split	Written themes	Themes feed Procurement / Ops actions
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Block D subtotal: ____ / 15

E. Talent & operating model (Q24–Q28) — 15 points

Q24. Process ownership A named AP Process Owner exists with authority to change design (not only firefight).

No owner	Owner in title only	Active owner	Owner + Controllership partnership

Q25. Capacity for design work Leadership protects time for process design / pilots (not 100% transactional).

None	Sporadic	Planned hours	Dedicated transformation / CoE hours

Q26. Skills mix Team includes people who can write procedures, read exception data, and challenge AI outputs.

Pure transactional	One power user	Small design-capable cohort	Cohort + training plan

Q27. Cross-functional access AP can engage Procurement, IT, and Controllership without months of politics for a pilot.

Siloed	Ad hoc favours	Named contacts	Standing forum / steering

Q28. Escalation culture People escalate ambiguity; they are not punished for slowing a payment run for control reasons.

Speed over control	Mixed signals	Escalation respected	Escalation celebrated in reviews

Block E subtotal: ____ / 15

F. AI readiness culture (Q29–Q32) — 16 points

Q29. Executive framing Leadership frames AI as controlled operating change — not “automate everything.”

Hype or fear only	Mixed messages	Clear “control first” narrative	Written AI / agent principles for Finance

Note: Q29 max = 4 (culture weight).

Q30. Experiment hygiene Shadow GenAI / ChatGPT use in AP is known and bounded (or prohibited with alternative).

Unknown shadow use	Aware; unmanaged	Policy exists	Policy + approved tooling path

Note: Q30 max = 4.

Q31. Evidence mindset The organisation refuses to claim AI success without baseline KPIs and retained artefacts.

Narrative claims OK	Some scepticism	KPI discipline emerging	Evidence standard written

Note: Q31 max = 4.

Q32. Autonomy appetite Stakeholders accept a responsibility ladder (observe → recommend → prepare → execute within guardrails) rather than “full autonomy now.”

Autonomy-or-bust	Confused	Accepts ladder verbally	Ladder adopted as programme rule

Note: Q32 max = 4.

Block F subtotal: ____ / 16

Score summary

A Process clarity	____ / 18	____
B Data & systems	____ / 18	____
C Controls & governance	____ / 18	____
D Exception load	____ / 15	____
E Talent & operating model	____ / 15	____
F AI readiness culture	____ / 16	____
TOTAL	____ / 100	—

4. Maturity bands

Emerging	0–39	Process, data, or control foundations are too weak for agent pilots beyond read-only observation.	Fix taxonomy, SoD, capture quality, and process ownership before agent charters.
Structured	40–59	Core AP is operable; agents can shadow and recommend in narrow scopes.	Stand up exception codes, baseline KPIs, one L0→L1 pilot agent.
Agent-Ready	60–79	Ready for multi-agent design under governance; controlled pilots with prepare-level ambition on low-risk work.	Full charters, control matrix, shadow→pilot gates, orchestrator discipline.

Operating	80–100	Operating evidence culture in place; expansion is gated by scorecards, not enthusiasm.	Scale agent families; deepen root-cause; keep payment auth human; periodic assurance.
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Interpretation rules

- A high total with **C < 50** → treat as one band lower for any write-capable pilot.
- A high total with **D < 40** → do not expand agents until exceptions are classified.
- **F < 40** → pause external AI tooling; fix framing and shadow-use policy first.

Bands describe **operating readiness**, not software maturity. They do not certify compliance, security, or accounting accuracy.

5. Opportunity heatmap — which agent families to prioritise

Map your dimension profile to agent families. Prioritise where pain is high **and** foundations allow control.

5.1 Agent families

Intake & validation	A01 Invoice Intake, A02 Invoice Validation	B (data), A (process)
Match & receipt	A03 Matching, A05 Goods Receipt, A06 PO Quality	A, B, D
Exception system	A04 Exception Triage, A15 Root Cause	D, C, E
Resolution & chase	A08 Supplier Resolution, A09 Internal Follow-Up	D, E, F
Control & anomaly	A10 Duplicate & Anomaly	C, B
Approval & pay prep	A07 Approval, A12 Payment Proposal Review	C (mandatory), A
Statement & close	A11 Vendor Statement Reconciliation, A13 AP Close	B, D, C
Reporting & orchestrate	A14 AP Reporting, A16 AP Manager / Orchestrator	E, F, all

5.2 Heatmap grid (fill after scoring)

Rate **Need** (1–5) from your exception/KPI pain and **Readiness** (1–5) from relevant subscores.

Intake & validation				L0→L1
Match & receipt				L0→L1
Exception system				L0→L1 (taxonomy first)
Resolution & chase				L1 drafts only

Control & anomaly				L0→L1 candidates
Approval & pay prep				L1; auth always human
Statement & close				L0→L1 packs
Reporting & orchestrate				L1 after 2+ agents live

Rule: Do not start with Approval & pay prep or write-heavy Matching if **C < 60**. Start with Exception system (classification) and Intake validation shadowing.

5.3 Sequencing heuristic

- 1 **Instrument exceptions** (A04 taxonomy) even before models.
- 2 **Shadow intake / validation / duplicate candidates.**
- 3 **Chase drafts** (A09 / A08) with human send gates.
- 4 **Match assist** where tolerances exist.
- 5 **Payment proposal review** as prepare-only — never release.
- 6 **Orchestrator** once ≥3 agents produce evidence.

6. Top-10 agent opportunity overview (brief)

Use this as a prioritisation menu — not a deployment order. Full blueprints live in Starter / Professional.

1	A04 Exception Triage	Uncoded backlog; inbox firefighting	Shared language; owned SLAs	Auto-clearing material exceptions without evidence
2	A01 Invoice Intake	Multi-channel chaos	Controlled queue; channel metrics	Silent drop of invoices
3	A02 Invoice Validation	Incomplete invoices cycle endlessly	Completeness gates; tax/ID checks	Inventing missing commercial facts
4	A10 Duplicate & Anomaly	Duplicate near-misses	Investigation packs; holds	Guaranteed fraud/duplicate detection
5	A05 Goods Receipt	GR lag dominates ageing	Chase packs to receivers	Posting GR without evidence policy
6	A09 Internal Follow-Up	Requester silence	Evidence-backed chases	Harassing without SLA / tone rules
7	A03 Matching	Match WIP high	Variance explanations	Force-match beyond tolerance
8	A11 Vendor Statement Reconciliation	Month-end noise	Discrepancy packs	Auto-settling disputes
9	A12 Payment Proposal Review	Proposal prep time	Flag holds / anomalies for humans	Payment authorisation / bank release

10	A15 Root Cause	Same codes every month	Preventable themes to Procurement/Ops	Blaming individuals without evidence
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Agents **A06, A07, A08, A13, A14, A16** remain important; they typically follow once the top pain families above have owners and scorecards.

7. Baseline KPI worksheet

Record **current** values before any agent pilot. Leave blank if unknown — unknown is itself a finding.

Invoice volume	Invoices registered in period				
STP / clean rate	% invoices with no exception code				
Exception volume	Count of open exceptions EOP				
Top 5 exception codes	Codes + % of exception hours				
Cycle time (receipt → ready for pay)	Median calendar days				
Aged >30 / >60 days (exceptions)	Count and \$				
On-time payment rate	% paid by due (policy definition)				
Duplicate candidates flagged	Count investigated				
Confirmed duplicate preventions / recoveries	Count / \$ (actuals only)				
Supplier query volume	Inbound chases to AP				
Touch time per invoice (sample)	Minutes — sample n≥30				
FTE in AP ops (excl. leadership)	Headcount / FTE				

First-pass approval rate	% approved without bounce				
Accrual / GRNI noise (qualitative)	High / Med / Low + note				

Evidence rule: For any future “before/after” claim, retain this sheet, extract date, and report ID. Narrative-only improvements are non-evidence.

8. Business case starter (assumption-labelled)

This section helps you structure a conversation with Finance leadership. All numeric scenarios below are **NON-EVIDENCE** — labelled assumptions for local modelling only. They are not market averages, savings guarantees, or ROI promises.

8.1 Problem statement (fill)

What breaks today?	
Who feels the pain?	
What control risk worries Controllership?	
What must remain human?	Payment authorisation; vendor bank changes; DOA overrides; ...

8.2 Scope hypothesis (fill)

Pilot entity / channel	
Agent candidates (max 2–3)	
Autonomy ceiling for pilot	L0 / L1 / L2 (circle)
Out of scope	Payment release; master bank edits; ...

8.3 Cost envelope (assumptions — label each)

Internal design time	e.g. 0.3 FTE × ____ weeks		
IT / integration	e.g. connector hours		
Tooling / LLM / RPA run	vendor quotes only		
Training / change	workshop hours		
Assurance / audit review	sampling hours		
Evidence Room toolkit (optional)	Starter US\$79 / Pro US\$199 / Team US\$499		

8.4 Benefit hypotheses (NON-EVIDENCE — do not present as guaranteed)

Express benefits as **measurement designs**, not promised outcomes:

Exception ageing for code X declines	Weekly ageing by code	Demote agent / fix process upstream
Touch minutes on sample decline	Time study n≥30	Redesign instructions
Duplicate investigated faster *candidates*	Cycle time on A10 packs	Keep L1; do not auto-block broader
Supplier chase response improves	SLA on A08/A09	Tone/policy revise

Do not put a single “\$ savings” number on an executive slide unless Controllershship accepts the assumptions and measurement method in writing.

8.5 Decision ask

Approve diagnostic band and pilot scope	
Approve baseline KPI capture (2–4 weeks)	
Approve autonomy ceiling	
Approve budget envelope (assumptions attached)	

9. Downloadable scorecard table

Copy into spreadsheet or print. Companion file: ER_AP_AI_Readiness_Scorecard.xlsx (if packaged).

1	A	Process map		
2	A	Role clarity		
3	A	Policy access		
4	A	Channel inventory		
5	A	STP definition		
6	A	Handoffs		
7	B	Master data		
8	B	Capture quality		
9	B	Match data		
10	B	Audit trail		
11	B	Integration		
12	B	Test environment		
13	C	SoD		
14	C	Duplicate controls		
15	C	DOA		
16	C	Payment auth		

17	C	Bank change		
18	C	Automation change control		
19	D	Exception taxonomy		
20	D	Ageing visibility		
21	D	Volume concentration		
22	D	Supplier queries		
23	D	Preventable split		
24	E	Process owner		
25	E	Design capacity		
26	E	Skills mix		
27	E	Cross-functional access		
28	E	Escalation culture		
29	F	Executive framing	*0–4*	
30	F	Experiment hygiene	*0–4*	
31	F	Evidence mindset	*0–4*	
32	F	Autonomy appetite	*0–4*	
		TOTAL	/100	Band:

10. What to do with your result

Emerging	Name Process Owner; inventory channels; draft 15–20 exception codes; verify payment SoD; stop unmanaged GenAI on live invoices.
Structured	Complete baseline KPI sheet; pick one agent for L0 shadow; write exclusions; stand up weekly exception review.
Agent-Ready	Charter 2–3 agents; define promotion gates; run shadow→pilot plan; brief Controller on autonomy ceiling.
Operating	Expand families under scorecards; introduce A15 root-cause cadence; assure logs; refuse autonomy without evidence.

11. Soft CTA — deepen the operating layer

This free diagnostic tells you **whether** you are ready and **where** to start.

To **design** agents with reusable artefacts:

AP Agent Starter Kit	US\$79	Condensed operating model, top-10 blueprints, exception taxonomy (major codes), templates, 90-day sketch, individual licence
AP Agent OS — Professional	US\$199	Full 16-agent library, governance framework, control matrix, KPI system, business-case model, implementation roadmap, shadow/UAT pack
AP Agent OS — Team	US\$499	Professional depth + workshop deck, facilitation, training, executive packs, implementation trackers, change toolkit (multi-user workshop licence)

Evidence Room does not replace your ERP. It gives Finance the operating evidence layer agents require.

12. Disclaimers

- 1 **Not professional advice.** This diagnostic is an educational operating toolkit. It is not legal, audit, accounting, tax, or investment advice.
- 2 **No guarantees.** Scores, bands, and heatmaps do not guarantee cost savings, fraud detection, regulatory compliance, control effectiveness, or accounting accuracy.
- 3 **No autonomous payments.** Nothing in this document authorises or recommends autonomous payment release. Payment authorisation remains a human accountability.
- 4 **Local calibration required.** Rubrics are design defaults. Controllorship and AP leadership must tune thresholds, materiality, and policy to local risk appetite.
- 5 **Non-evidence scenarios.** Any illustrative numbers in the business-case starter are labelled assumptions for modelling — not researched market outcomes.
- 6 **IP and confidentiality.** Do not paste confidential invoice, vendor banking, or personal data into public AI tools when completing this diagnostic.
- 7 **Version.** Diagnostic v1.0 — align updates with your internal document control if adopted as a controlled form.

Evidence Room — Operating Evidence for AP agents. *Document ER-FREE-DIAG-001 v1.0*